

The Love of God Defeats Greed

On my way back from a passion play in Oklahoma City, I was concerned about the presence of God in the play, which was almost zero. Yet angels flew on wires. There was a resurrection scene and all kinds of production.

On the way back I was musing, wondering based on what I already knew: what would it take to bring an anointing to a passion play like that?

Sometimes He answers directly. Sometimes He says things like, "If you went home and worshiped Me all night, you would begin to find out."

What praying in tongues was doing was giving me the key that unlocked the door to worship so I could receive what worship could give me.

I had a key I used seldom, one I had to sand the rust off. I used it at the fasting door, and that door opened. I was in and out of that door several times over a few years.

When Jesus came down from the mountain after speaking with Moses and Elijah, He was speaking with the law and the prophets. They did not come down from heaven, because no one had been born again yet. Jesus was the firstborn of many brethren. They came from paradise.

They were obviously talking about His coming death, resurrection, and ascension. Everyone who was waiting for the promise made in the Garden of Eden, the Seed of the woman who would bruise the serpent's head, would soon be led into heaven.

Psalm 22 says, "They pierced My hands and My feet." Psalm 23 says, "I walk through the valley of the shadow of death," but He was not staying there. Psalm 24 says, "Open up, gates." The Lord of hosts was coming through, and He had quite a procession with Him.

When He unlocked the door to worship, I started worshiping. You wear out every traditional form: playing and singing, listening to worship music. Finally it ended up being just me and Him in a little soundproof room where I was supposed to make radio tapes, learning what it meant to stay in there.

I had many dry times, especially in the first thirty hours or so. My words would get pancake flat and fall to the floor. I felt like I needed a spatula to get them up to heaven.

Until I received a visitation, I thought I was losing ground because I did not feel His presence. I felt resistance. I would say, "I love You. I love You. I love You," and meet resistance for hours.

The only reasons I did not stop were, first, because He had spoken to me; and second, because I am stubborn.

When revelation finally explained what was happening, I found that I was getting more done when hell was camped on me. I was pushing past every place I had ever been before, into territory worth stopping.

I am glad I did not stop.

We have limited knowledge of the Old Testament and even of Satan. He was perfect in his ways in the beginning. He was created. We do not know how long ago that was. We do not know everything he did. A third of the angels followed him, and we do not know how he evangelized them.

Preachers say Satan has no salvation because he had no tempter. But a third of the angels did have a tempter. Did they get a chance? Scripture does not fill us in on all that history.

But if I were to say God had a weakness, I would categorize it this way: it is you.

The most costly thing heaven endured was our right to make choices. I understand now that, even though He is God and totally self-sufficient, there is something about fellowship He values.

If I made a robot and programmed it to say, "I love you," what would that mean to me? I would know I programmed it in.

But you are you, and there is something He wants from you. He called you family.

It cost heaven for us to have the right to make choices.

The love of God opened to me in Brazil in ways I had not understood before. Here is one simple thing:

If I ask, "Do you love God?" and you say, "Yes," what do you have?

Some say, "I have His love. God gave me His love."

Does that mean you are loving Him back with love He put in you, and you are only borrowing it to give it back? That would not really be from you, would it?

When you were born again, your spirit received a capacity not only to have His nature, but to develop a love like His. When that love develops in your new nature, it becomes your love toward Him.

Every time Paul talks about doing majestic things for God, he points to love. He says to desire earnestly the best gifts: apostles, prophets, teachers, miracles, gifts of healings. Then he pauses and says, "Yet shew I unto you a more excellent way."

A more excellent way to what? To desire the best gifts.

Then he begins 1 Corinthians 13:

"Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels,
and have not charity,
I am become as sounding brass,
or a tinkling cymbal."

He goes on to say that if he had faith to move mountains but did not have love, he was nothing.

If you seek the love of God with the same tenacity with which you wanted glory and power, you will get there quicker.

I knew true revival was dangerous. You do not have to study revival history very far to find out how dangerous it is.

I watched God try to do all He could. He gives people more power, trying to get as much out as He can. I remember when the devil tried to take me out after miracles began working. People would throw crutches up, and we had crutches and other things left in front of the curtain.

I remember taking a step into that world. Before I took another step, I wanted to do another meeting. I did, and God did the same miracles. I took another step, then another.

About that time, the devil made a big move.

This last trip, I encountered devils like that. I was on the other side of the world, as far from home as I could get, and I saw the devil in charge of the devils. I saw the whole group. They did not go away immediately, so I dealt with them. When it was over, I had won.

They had been camped at the door of the love of God I had been looking for. Their assignment was to keep me from going through it.

That is just too bad.

My spirit has the capacity to develop the love of God. It is His love, yes, but it develops in you as an individual through the new nature you received when you were born again into His family.

How important is it?

Jesus said if you have faith, you can say to the mountain, "Be removed and cast into the sea," and it will obey you. But then He waved a red flag: if you have ought against someone, stop praying, go fix it, then come back.

If greed is the reason you are giving, put the offering back in your pocket. When you bring your offering and remember someone has something against you, take it back, fix the matter, then come back and give.

Why did He leave us here? He has no other way to reach people. We are born again and headed to heaven, but He left us in these bodies to reach others. Whatever it takes to overcome the flesh and finish what He called us to do, that is where reward comes in. Reward is not for salvation. It is for

what you overcome and fulfill after grace has saved you.

When the love of God develops, you love people more than what they can do to you.

You lift your hands and say, "Father God, I love You. Jesus, I love You. I do not know how to tell You how much. I am starting to see how much You love me. You came after me."

He could have called legions of angels, but He chose the cup. He came after me. He came after you.

When I lift my hands and tell my Father I love Him, and tell Jesus I love Him, He knows it is my choice. He did not make me. He did not break my arm. I choose to tell Him I love Him.

The true love of God in manifestation will defeat covetousness and greed. It will send greed running.

The parables show heaven rejoicing over the lost. Heaven rejoices over one sheep that was lost and found. The woman who lost a piece of silver called her friends to celebrate when she found it. The father rejoiced when the prodigal returned.

The elder brother said, "You never killed a fatted calf for me."

The father said, "Son, all I have is yours. But this your brother was dead and is alive again; he was lost and is found."

In effect, the father was saying, "The problem is that I am your father, and you do not know Me well enough to know what has always been yours."

The next parable gets into money. A steward cheated his rich man, then used the rich man's authority to cancel portions of people's debts so they would receive him later.

Jesus said:

"Make to yourselves friends of the mammon of unrighteousness;
that, when ye fail,
they may receive you into everlasting habitations."

The unjust steward used the authority of his rich man's name to write off debts. You have the power of attorney in the name of your Rich Man. In His name, you can cancel people's debt against God, the sin question.

That is a good use for money: use the power in money to get people's debt against God canceled. When you walk into heaven, every dollar used to get someone born again will be waiting to celebrate.

Years ago, in the prophecy on endurance, He warned us severely that we would be asked to endure until it looked beyond endurance. He did not want us to pull up short and be destroyed along the way, before becoming effective on a full-scale, God-scale.

When I read that prophecy again while praying, He asked, "Do you understand this now?"

I almost lost it. I said, "Yes, sir."

"And you are telling me the love of God can prevent all that?"

Yes. That is why Paul added it to 1 Corinthians 13. Love never fails and has no fear. I am not talking about the phony stuff. Genuine love has no destructive fear, and it never fails.

When love is moving tangibly, it is compassion. That is why when Jesus was moved by compassion, He healed them.

The first time He walked me through this, He took me back to men of old.

Alexander Dowie shook Chicago to its knees, but at the end of his days he ascended onto his own little throne with a tall hat, chains, and paraphernalia, declaring he was Elijah to come. He started buying land around Israel because he believed he would rule and reign through the millennium with Jesus.

William Branham had tremendous power. He could tell people what was wrong with them and they would be healed. I remember hearing about him saying to a woman, "You do not like being in that wheelchair, do you?"

She said, "No."

He said, "Then get out."

What could go wrong with someone like that?

Yet later, he went into serious error. He claimed he was Elijah to come. At one point he taught things about women that were deeply wrong. He even believed his palate was formed so he alone could pronounce God's name correctly, and that the catching away of the church could not happen until he said that word.

These men shook nations. They saw signs and wonders. But the devil is better at religion than he is at stopping someone who is troubling cities. If he can get one person messed up, that person can teach others how to be messed up.

I am not buying it.

When Paul wrote Romans, he did not have the whole New Testament in his lap. He was writing some of the most difficult parts about us being born again, the law, Jews, Gentiles, and the will and plan of God. He could not turn to Matthew, Mark, Luke, John, Jude, James, Titus, or the whole canon the way we can.

Yet Paul, the one responsible for major revelation knowledge, said:

"I thank my God,
I speak with tongues more than ye all."

Now this walk is unfolding, and its primary objective is not power anymore. It is not achievements that can be recognized. It is the love of God.

Do you understand what Paul means when he says if you do not have love, you do not have it? I am beginning to.

How can something control you when it loses its power?

I cannot stand knowing what is there and stay where I am. I feel secure, full of peace, happy, and know there is a revival unfolding in front of me.

Years ago I saw a vision and did not know what it was. The earth was here, a light region there, and a black belt around it, then a bright region beyond it. I landed on the planet in the medium region, between the darkness and the brightness.

I said, "That black belt is the devil, isn't it?"

God said, "No, that is your flesh."

"What is on the other side?"

"My power. My operation. The fullness of it."

People were clawing their way up. One got his hand through and came back and laid hands on people, and they were healed. One got his head through. But someone made it all the way through, shot back, and glowed with the same fire when he hit the earth. Where he landed, the dark place kindled into a raging forest fire of revival. Others followed and shot off, and wherever they landed, it caught fire too.

I do not care who it is anymore. Just do it.

Perfect love kills greed. Perfect love casts out fear because you do not have anything to fear if you are not going to fail.

Testings and trials come anyway. You might as well learn something from them. God did not send them. Did He send Satan to Adam? Then He did not send your problem to you. But He will use what happens to you if you are teachable.

Hear what the Spirit would say:

There is much, much that I desire to say. I rarely get the opportunity to say it in most church orders. Truths are taught, yes, but I hardly ever get to speak My mind, My plan among you, not only for the hour but for what is to come.

It is My desire to be free to manifest what is in My heart and mind for you in the very moment you live in.

If I yield and do not take my own path, generally He will keep teaching us what is coming, what has happened, how the devil has fought it, and what is available. He wants to speak His mind and make us know that these things are attainable.

If you are here this morning, I may not be able in the time allotted to convince you how important this next step into the Spirit is. The very next thing on the list after being born again is being filled with the Holy Ghost. He is the Teacher who guides you into all truth.

"But I cannot speak with tongues."

Tongues is the plan God has for your personal life being prayed out so it can be answered.

"If I pray in an unknown tongue,
my spirit prayeth,
but my understanding is unfruitful."

In the Spirit, you speak mysteries. Along with the plan unfolding for you, you begin to understand the mysteries of who Christ is in you, the hope of glory: His love, power, and peace.

"But I cannot pray with tongues."

Come. The only thing keeping you from doing that is coming up here.